

U N I T 2 · L E S S O N 4

Being Kind to Myself

20–25 min · Week 11 · PPRA · Counselor Briefed

O B J E C T I V E	Students articulate that they deserve the same kindness they give a friend, and practise turning kind words inward toward themselves.
C A S E L F O C U S	Self-Management · self-compassion (adapted from Dr. Kristin Neff's framework)
V O C A B U L A R Y	self-compassion · kindness · good friend · common humanity · notice the feeling
M A T E R I A L S	Sammy puppet · Three Parts of Being Kind to Yourself anchor chart · card-fold paper for the kind message

ILLINOIS SEL ALIGNMENT GRADES K-2 · EARLY ELEMENTARY

Goal 1 — Self-Awareness & Self-Management

1A.1a Recognize and accurately label emotions and how they are linked to behavior.

1B.1a Identify one's likes and dislikes, needs and wants, strengths and challenges.

Aligned to the Illinois Social/Emotional Learning Standards (ISBE).

SAFETY CHECK

PPRA-designated lesson. Family notification confirmed. Standard opt-out protocols apply. See [Section 4](#), Legal & Clinical Compliance.

Counselor briefed in advance. Counselor on standby — reachable same-day.

During the kind-message activity, some students who are heavily critical of themselves may become quietly emotional. This is healthy — they may be receiving permission they have never been given. Do not draw class attention. Acknowledge privately.

O P E N I N G R E V I E W · 1 – 2 M I N

Show the Three-Part Real Sorry chart. "Last lesson: how to apologize to others. Today: a different question. When WE make a mistake — how do we talk to OURSELVES?"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have a question that surprised me. If a friend made a mistake — I would be kind to them. But when I make a mistake — I am MEAN to myself. Why?"

► DIRECT INSTRUCTION

Scripted teaching sequence · 4 STEPS · read aloud or in your own words

01 The Friend Test**5 MIN**

Pose the test: "Imagine your best friend made a mistake. They feel terrible. What would you SAY to them?" Take 3–4 student responses. Write the words on chart paper. Then ask: "Would you say those same words to YOURSELF?"

02 Part One — Self-Kindness**4 MIN**

Build the first part: "When YOU make a mistake — talk to yourself like you would talk to a good friend. 'I care about you. This is hard. You are doing your best.' Speak to yourself with care — not with cruelty."

03 Part Two — Common Humanity**4 MIN**

Add the second part: "When you make a mistake, remember: EVERYONE goes through hard things. Everyone makes mistakes. Everyone hurts sometimes. You are NOT alone. You are HUMAN."

04 Part Three — Mindfulness**5 MIN**

The third part: "Notice the feeling. Don't push it away — but don't drown in it. Just NOTICE: 'I am feeling sad right now.' 'I am feeling angry right now.' Naming it makes it smaller." End with the Drawing Activity — see the polished reference for the complete protocol.

Sammy: *"I deserve the same kindness I give my friends."*

KINDERGARTEN**GRADES 1 – 2**

The Friend Test is the centerpiece. The three parts can be condensed to one line: "Be kind to yourself — like you would be to a friend." The

Add the language of all three parts. Students complete the Drawing Activity card with their own kind message. Pair-share what they wrote

Kind Message activity is the artifact. (optional).

EXIT TICKET

"Look at your own hand. Make the Sammy thumbs-up. Say to yourself: "I care about you. Everyone goes through hard things. I am noticing this feeling.""

Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students could not generate ANY kind words for themselves — even when prompted with what they would say to a friend? These students need extra support. Note for counselor.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Students who became quietly emotional during the Kind Message activity — likely receiving permission they have never been given.

Acknowledge privately. Counselor follow-up if pattern continues.

Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

A Note Home

Today we learned the three parts of being kind to ourselves: self-kindness, common humanity, mindfulness. Adapted from Dr. Kristin Neff's research on self-compassion. At home, model kind self-talk audibly: "I made a mistake — it is okay — I will try again."

A N C H O R C H A R T · U N I T 2 · L E S S O N 4

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

ANCHOR CHART · CLASSROOM DISPLAY — PRINT ON CARDSTOCK OR 11×17, POST AS THE LESSON INDICATES

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · BOOK 1 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

Being Kind to Myself

Three ways to be a friend to me

SELF-COMPASSION

1

Self-Kindness

"I care about you. This is hard. You are doing your best."

2

Common Humanity

Everyone makes mistakes. Everyone hurts sometimes. You are NOT alone.
You are human.

3

Mindfulness

Notice the feeling: "I am feeling sad right now." Naming it makes it smaller.

Talk to yourself the way you would talk to a good friend.

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE FOUNDATION · CONFIDENTIAL — FOR DISTRICT REVIEW ONLY

UNIT 2 · LESSON 4

PRE-WORKSHEET

Three Parts of Being Kind to Yourself

Talk to Yourself Like You Would a Good Friend

What would you say to a friend who felt this way? Say it to yourself instead.

1

PART ONE

SELF-KINDNESS

"I care about you."

Speak to yourself with care, not cruelty — like you would talk to a good friend.

2

PART TWO

COMMON HUMANITY

"Everyone goes through hard things."

You are not alone. Everyone makes mistakes. Everyone hurts sometimes.

3

PART THREE

MINDFULNESS

"I notice I am feeling ____."

See the feeling clearly. Don't push it away — but don't drown in it either.

Adapted from Dr. Kristin Neff's Self-Compassion framework

TEACHER NOTE

Post before distributing the worksheet. Reference in every Unit 2 lesson.

D R A W I N G A C T I V I T Y · U N I T 2 · L E S S O N
4

Teacher reference · Print and post during the activity

UNIT 2 · LESSON 4 · DRAWING ACTIVITY 4

SELF-COMPASSION

Kind Message to Myself

A self-compassion letter — in K-2 form

*Students fold a piece of paper into a card. Outside: "To: Me. From: Me."
Inside: a kind message in the voice of the Kind Coach — not Grumpy Gus.*

OUTSIDE

To: Me.
From: Me.

♥

INSIDE

"Dear me,
you made a mistake.
That is okay.
You are still good."
— the Kind Coach

STEP-BY-STEP STUDENT INSTRUCTIONS

1
FOLD

Students fold paper in half to create a card.

2
OUTSIDE

Write "To: Me. From: Me." — decorate as desired.

3
INSIDE

Write or draw a kind message to themselves about a mistake.

4
VOICE

The message should be in the voice of the *Kind Coach* — not Grumpy Gus.

5
PROMPT

If needed: "What would the Kind Coach say to you right now?"

PRIVACY PROTOCOL

Students fold and keep — or take home. Never displayed. Never collected without student invitation.

TEACHER NOTE

This is the self-compassion letter in K-2 form. The act of writing to yourself as a friend is the key insight. Pair with the Three Parts of Being Kind to Yourself anchor chart.

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 2 · LESSON 4

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

UNIT 2 · SELF-COMPASSION & SELF-FORGIVENESS · OCT-DEC

Being Kind to Myself

CUT VERTICALLY · LAMINATE · REUSE

SCENARIO · 2-G Being Kind to Myself

THE SITUATION

After falling off her bike, Zara said to herself, "You are so stupid. You can't do anything." Her friend was right there and heard it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- ▶ Would Zara say that to her friend if HER friend had fallen?
- ▶ What would Zara say to her friend instead?
- ▶ Can you say that same kind thing to yourself?

SCENARIO · 2-H Being Kind to Myself

THE SITUATION

When Liam got a low score on his art project, his mom said, "Don't worry, it doesn't matter at all!" But Liam still felt sad.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- ▶ Why didn't his mom's words help?
- ▶ Is it OK to feel sad about something that matters to you?
- ▶ What would a KIND and HONEST inside voice say?

D R A W I N G E X A M P L E · U N I T 2 · L E S S O N
4

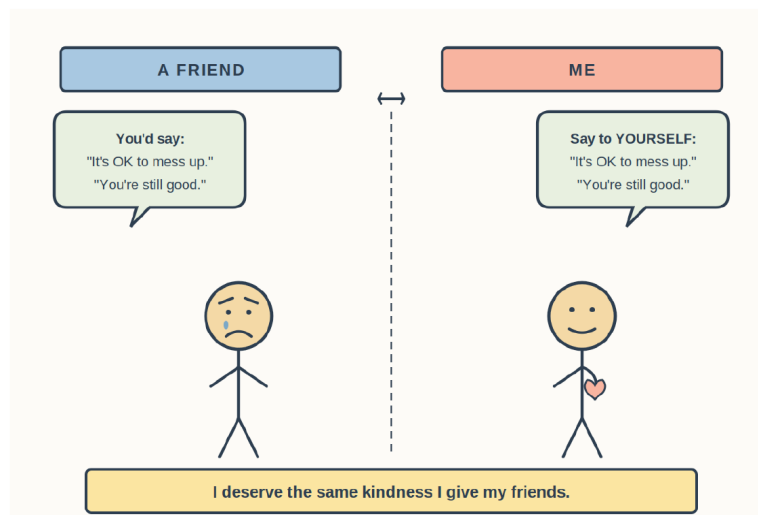
Visual reference for the drawing activity

DRAWING EXAMPLES · TEACHER REFERENCE

UNIT 2 · LESSON 4 · DRAWING EXAMPLE 8

SELF-COMPASSION LETTER

Students illustrate the kind thing they would say to a friend — then write it to themselves.



HOW TO DRAW IT

- ▶ On the left side of the page: draw a friend who is sad or struggling.
- ▶ In a speech bubble next to them: write the kind thing you would say.
- ▶ On the right side: draw yourself.
- ▶ In a speech bubble: write the same kind thing — but say it to yourself.
- ▶ At the bottom: "I deserve the same kindness I give my friends."

TEACHER NOTE

This is the core insight of self-compassion. Model by sharing your own example first. The two drawings should look similar — friend and self, same words.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Sample Lesson · Book 1 · The Foundation (K–2)

The complete, classroom-ready curriculum — with anchor charts, worksheets, Illinois SEL alignment, and scripted Direct Instruction — is part of the Architecture of Grace district library. Educators can license the full set; families can find materials in the family store.

architectureofgrace.org